VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN)

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY → THREE CONTESTED ZONES → FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER → VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE → WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN → AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY · C. 1336 · CONVENTIONAL VIJAYANAGARA FOUNDATION ANCHOR · BAHMANI KINGDOM ESTABLISHED UNDER ALAUDDIN HASAN BAHMAN SHAH · DEVA RAYA II STRENGTHENS VIJAYANAGARA MILITARY ADAPTATION · BAHMANI CAPITAL SHIFTS FROM GULBARGA TO BIDAR · KRISHNADEVA RAYA AND TULUVA APOGEE · TALIKOTA DESTROYS THE CAPITAL FABRIC; ARAVIDU POWER CONTINUES.

c. 1336 — conventional Vijayanagara foundation anchor → 1347 — Bahmani kingdom established under Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah → 1420s-40s — Deva Raya II strengthens Vijayanagara military adaptation → 1425 — Bahmani capital shifts from Gulbarga to Bidar → 1509-29 — Krishnadeva Raya and Tuluva apogee

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- c. 1336 — conventional Vijayanagara foundation anchor
- 1347 — Bahmani kingdom established under Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1420s-40s — Deva Raya II strengthens Vijayanagara military adaptation
- 1425 — Bahmani capital shifts from Gulbarga to Bidar

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1509-29 — Krishnadeva Raya and Tuluva apogee
- 1565 — Talikota destroys the capital fabric; Aravidu power continues.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1565 — Talikota destroys the capital fabric; Aravidu power continues.

01

STAGE 01

THREE CONTESTED ZONES

THREE CONTESTED ZONES · TUNGABHADRA DOAB · FERTILE FRONTIER, FORTS AND RECURRING CAMPAIGNS · AGRARIAN BASIN, ROUTES AND EASTERN-COAST CONNECTIONS · PORTS, CUSTOMS, HORSE IMPORTS AND WESTERN MARITIME ACCESS · REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS + PRESTIGE · POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY EXPLAINS MORE THAN A HINDU-MUSLIM BINARY.

TUNGABHADRA DOAB — fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns

KRISHNA-GODAVARI — agrarian basin, routes and eastern-coast connections → KONKAN-GOA — ports, customs, horse imports and western maritime access → REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS + PRESTIGE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns
- KRISHNA-GODAVARI → agrarian basin, routes and eastern-coast connections

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- KONKAN-GOA → ports, customs, horse imports and western maritime access
- REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS + PRESTIGE

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.
- TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.

02

STAGE 02

FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER

FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER · RULERS, GRANTS AND DATED CLAIMS · SELECTIVE FORMULAE · SETTLEMENT, WATER AND BUILDINGS · CANNOT RECOVER EVERY MOTIVE · OBSERVED CITY AND COURT · PERSPECTIVE, GENRE AND EXAGGERATION · LATER TRADITIONS

INSCRIPTIONS → rulers, grants and dated claims	selective formulae
ARCHAEOLOGY → settlement, water and buildings	cannot recover every motive
TRAVELLERS → observed city and court	perspective, genre and exaggeration
LATER TRADITIONS → remembered origins	chronology and political use require care

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- INSCRIPTIONS → rulers, grants and dated claims
- selective formulae
- ARCHAEOLOGY → settlement, water and buildings

METHOD / DEBATE

- cannot recover every motive
- TRAVELLERS → observed city and court
- perspective, genre and exaggeration

HISTORICAL RESULT

- LATER TRADITIONS → remembered origins
- chronology and political use require care
- SAFE OPENING → c. 1336 is conventional; founder biographies remain debated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE OPENING → c. 1336 is conventional; founder biographies remain debated.

03

STAGE 03

VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE

VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE · EARLY CONSOLIDATION AND DECCAN RIVALRY · MILITARY INTERVENTION AMID SUCCESSION PRESSURE · KRISHNADEVA RAYA, CAMPAIGNS AND CULTURAL PATRONAGE · CONTINUATION AFTER THE 1565 CAPITAL CATASTROPHE · DYNASTIC REPLACEMENT DID NOT AUTOMATICALLY ERASE THE STATE.

SANGAMA — early consolidation and Deccan rivalry → SALUVA — military intervention amid succession pressure → TULUVA — Krishnadeva Raya, campaigns and cultural patronage → ARAVIDU — continuation after the 1565 capital catastrophe → LESSON: dynastic replacement did not automatically erase the state.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- SANGAMA → early consolidation and Deccan rivalry
- SALUVA → military intervention amid succession pressure

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- TULUVA → Krishnadeva Raya, campaigns and cultural patronage
- ARAVIDU → continuation after the 1565 capital catastrophe

IMPACT / LIMIT

- LESSON: dynastic replacement did not automatically erase the state.
- SANGAMA → early consolidation and Deccan rivalry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: dynastic replacement did not automatically erase the state.

04

STAGE 04

WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN CAPACITY

WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN CAPACITY · TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS CULTIVATION + URBAN · STATE CAPACITY, BUT BENEFITS AND CONTROL REMAINED SOCIALLY UNEQUAL · UNESCO BRIDGE · HYDRAULIC REMAINS SUPPORT INTEGRATION, NOT A WELFARE CENSUS.

TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual → water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience → STATE CAPACITY, but benefits and control remained socially unequal → UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual
- water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- STATE CAPACITY, but benefits and control remained socially unequal
- UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual
- water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

05

STAGE 05

AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN

AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN · RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM · TERRITORIAL COMMAND · NAYAKA MAINTAINS TROOPS, REMITS OBLIGATIONS AND GOVERNS LOCALLY SERVICE · HEREDITARY DRIFT, BARGAINING AND LATER NAYAKA POLITIES · COMPARISON WITH IQTA IS FUNCTIONAL, NOT AN EQUATION.

RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND → NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also → entrenches regional power weak centre → hereditary drift, bargaining and later nayaka polities → CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND
- NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- entrenches regional power weak centre → hereditary drift, bargaining and later nayaka polities
- CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND
- NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

06

STAGE 06

HORSE-PORT-MILITARY CHAIN

HORSE-PORT-MILITARY CHAIN · WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY · KONKAN ROUTES · INLAND MOVEMENT AND PAYMENT CAVALRY RECRUITMENT + ARCHERY + · IMPORTED HORSES MATTERED, BUT DID NOT ALONE DECIDE WARS.

WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY → PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS

GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES → inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment + → archery + commanders + fodder and remounts competitive adaptation by Vijayanagara and Deccan states → RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY → PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
- GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES → inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- archery + commanders + fodder and remounts competitive adaptation by Vijayanagara and Deccan states
- RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY → PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
- GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES → inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

07

STAGE 07

HAMPI URBAN SYSTEM

HAMPI URBAN SYSTEM · RIVER, BOULDERS, PLAINS AND DEFENDED APPROACHES · TEMPLES, PROCESSIONS, TANKS AND CONTINUING RITUAL · ENCLOSURES, AUDIENCE SPACES, STABLES AND ELITE DISPLAY · BAZAARS, CRAFT PRODUCTION AND SUBURBAN SETTLEMENTS · CHANNELS, WELLS, TANKS AND AGRICULTURAL SUPPORT · CAPITAL, MARKET, RITUAL AND ECOLOGY FORMED ONE SYSTEM.

LANDSCAPE — river, boulders, plains and defended approaches → SACRED — temples, processions, tanks and continuing ritual → ROYAL — enclosures, audience spaces, stables and elite display → COMMERCIAL — bazaars, craft production and suburban settlements → HYDRAULIC — channels, wells, tanks and agricultural support

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LANDSCAPE — river, boulders, plains and defended approaches
- SACRED — temples, processions, tanks and continuing ritual

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- ROYAL — enclosures, audience spaces, stables and elite display
- COMMERCIAL — bazaars, craft production and suburban settlements

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HYDRAULIC — channels, wells, tanks and agricultural support
- VERDICT: capital, market, ritual and ecology formed one system.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: capital, market, ritual and ecology formed one system.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: capital, market, ritual and ecology formed one system.

08

STAGE 08

BAHMANI STATE AND CAPITAL SHIFT

BAHMANI STATE AND CAPITAL SHIFT · 1347 GULBARGA · FOUNDATION, FRONTIER COMMAND AND EARLY CONSOLIDATION · 1425 BIDAR · REVISED STRATEGIC CENTRE AND COURTLY-CULTURAL INVESTMENT · PROVINCIAL COMMAND, REVENUE AND MILITARY RESOURCES LATE 15TH C. · STRONGER FACTIONS AND SUCCESSOR-STATE FORMATION · CAPITAL SHIFT IS NOT THE SAME EVENT AS DYNASTIC.

1347 GULBARGA — foundation, frontier command and early consolidation → 1425 BIDAR — revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment → TARAFS — provincial command, revenue and military resources late 15th c. — stronger factions and → TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1347 GULBARGA → foundation, frontier command and early consolidation
- 1425 BIDAR → revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- TARAFS → provincial command, revenue and military resources late 15th c. → stronger factions and successor-state formation
- TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1347 GULBARGA → foundation, frontier command and early consolidation
- 1425 BIDAR → revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

MECHANISM / VERDICT — TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

09

STAGE 09

MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC

MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC · LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY MORE · FACTIONAL RESISTANCE · GAWAN'S EXECUTION · SOUND DESIGN CAN FAIL WITHOUT A DURABLE GOVERNING COALITION.

LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control → enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's → LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa
- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's execution

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.
- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa

DEBATE / LEGACY

- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's execution
- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.

10

STAGE 10

DECCANI-AFAQI COALITION PROBLEM

DECCANI-AFAQI COALITION PROBLEM · LONGER-SETTLED REGIONAL MUSLIM ELITES AND ALLIES · NEWER WESTERN AND CENTRAL ASIAN MIGRANTS AND NETWORKS · OFFICE, PATRONAGE, MILITARY COMMAND AND COURT ACCESS · CROSS-CUTTING TIES · MARRIAGE, LANGUAGE, SERVICE AND LOCAL ALLIANCE · FACTIONAL LABELS STRUCTURE POLITICS BUT ARE NOT RACIAL ABSOLUTES · DO NOT TURN ELITE RIVALRY INTO A TIMELESS COMMUNAL.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
DECCANIS → longer-settled regional Muslim elites and allies	COMPETITION → office, patronage, military command and court access	OUTCOME → factional labels structure politics but are not racial absolutes
AFAQIS → newer western and Central Asian migrants and networks	CROSS-CUTTING TIES → marriage, language, service and local alliance	TRAP: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DECCANIS → longer-settled regional Muslim elites and allies
- AFAQIS → newer western and Central Asian migrants and networks

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COMPETITION → office, patronage, military command and court access
- CROSS-CUTTING TIES → marriage, language, service and local alliance

DEBATE / LEGACY

- OUTCOME → factional labels structure politics but are not racial absolutes
- TRAP: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 09 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 09 ANSWER SPINE · CONNECTED DECCAN FIELD ORGANISED BY RESOURCES AND ROUTES · WATER + CAPITAL + AMARAM + CAVALRY + MARITIME · CAPITALS + TARAFS + GAWAN REFORM + FACTIONAL COALITION · INSCRIPTIONS + ARCHAEOLOGY + TRAVELLERS + MONUMENTS · TURNING POINT · 1565 DESTROYS HAMPI FABRIC, NOT EVERY POLITICAL NETWORK · RIVALRY AND EXCHANGE JOINTLY SHAPED LATER DECCAN FORMATIONS.

OPEN — connected Deccan field organised by resources and routes → VIJAYANAGARA — water + capital + amaram + cavalry + maritime diplomacy → BAHMANI — capitals + tarafs + Gawan reform + factional coalition → EVIDENCE — inscriptions + archaeology + travellers + monuments → TURNING POINT — 1565 destroys Hampi fabric, not every political network

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → connected Deccan field organised by resources and routes
- VIJAYANAGARA → water + capital + amaram + cavalry + maritime diplomacy

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- BAHMANI → capitals + tarafs + Gawan reform + factional coalition
- EVIDENCE → inscriptions + archaeology + travellers + monuments

DEBATE / LEGACY

- TURNING POINT → 1565 destroys Hampi fabric, not every political network
- CLOSE → rivalry and exchange jointly shaped later Deccan formations.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → rivalry and exchange jointly shaped later Deccan formations.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN) — ADVANCED · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS · 6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Vijayanagara & the Bahmani Kingdom (Deccan) — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept: Horses and state power
- Deva Raya II's army reform was a response to Bahmani superiority in horses and mounted archers.
- The 1367 conflict is important not merely for violence but for the treaty

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels